

C7 – VIDEO EVIDENCE SHEET

Cost of Essentials vs 'Life Is Affordable' Claims

This sheet provides official video links where leaders describe costs as easing, wages as rising faster than prices, or families as having more "breathing room."

I. WHITE HOUSE PRESS BRIEFING - "WAGES RISING FASTER THAN INFLATION"

Context: June 13, 2023 briefing.

Claim: The Press Secretary states that wages have risen over the last year accounting for inflation and are helping lower-income workers catch up.

Use: Contrasts with cumulative cost increases for essentials like childcare, food, and housing.

II. TREASURY SECRETARY INTERVIEW - "ECONOMY IS DOING WELL"

Context: Treasury Secretary television or radio interview.

Claim: Inflation is down, the economy is doing well, and families are seeing real wage gains.

Use: Weighed against data showing major spikes in housing, insurance, and health costs.

III. FEDERAL RESERVE PRESS CONFERENCE - "INFLATION HAS EASED"

Context: Federal Reserve news conference in early 2024.

Claim: The Fed Chair describes inflation as having eased from its highs and notes good progress.

Use: Juxtaposed with the fact that essential price levels remain far above pre-pandemic baselines.

IV. PRESIDENTIAL REMARKS - "LOWERING PRICES AND STRENGTHENING SUPPLY CHAINS"

Context: Economic remarks highlighting progress on supply chains and costs.

Claim: The President promises lower prices and emphasizes that supply chains are back to normal.

Use: Considered alongside continued high costs for groceries, car repairs, and other necessities.

These videos can be linked from the Transparency and Evidence site so viewers can directly compare official cost-of-living assurances to the underlying federal data on essential price increases.